MEDIUM

EXPRESSION OF IDEAS

Mixed

03

10 questions · ~15 min

SAT QUESTION BANK

2026-05-29

Q1 EXPRESSION OF IDEAS

To discover which fruit varieties were grown in Italy's Umbria region before the introduction of industrial farming, botanist Isabella Dalla Ragione often turns to centuries-old lists of cooking ingredients. ______blank she analyzes Renaissance paintings of Umbria, as they can provide accurate representations of fruits that were grown there long ago.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. In sum,

B. Instead,

C. Thus,

D. Additionally,

Q2

EXPRESSION OF IDEAS

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- Mary Kang is a Korean American portrait photographer.
- She is based in New York City and in Austin, Texas.
- One of Kang's photographs features artist Dominique Fung.
- In the portrait, Fung is seated on the floor.
- Five of Fung's paintings are resting against the wall behind her.

The student wants to describe where Fung is in the photograph to an audience already familiar with Kang and Fung. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

A. Dominique Fung is in a photograph by Mary Kang, a portrait photographer based in New York City and Austin, Texas.

B. Mary Kang is a photographer based in both New York City and Austin, Texas.

C. Five paintings by artist Dominique Fung can be seen in the background of Mary Kang's photograph.

D. In Kang's portrait of her, Fung is seated on the floor, with five of her paintings resting against the wall behind her.

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- The melting rate of glaciers varies based on air temperature.
- In the warm summer months, massive glaciers on the coast of Greenland melt into the surrounding water.
- The melting glaciers contribute to rising sea levels each summer.
- Huge icebergs also break off Greenland's glaciers into the water and melt.
- In 2017, geoscientist Twila Moon found that the iceberg melting rate depends not on air temperature but on water temperature.
- Because water temperature is consistent, melting icebergs contribute to rising sea levels all year.

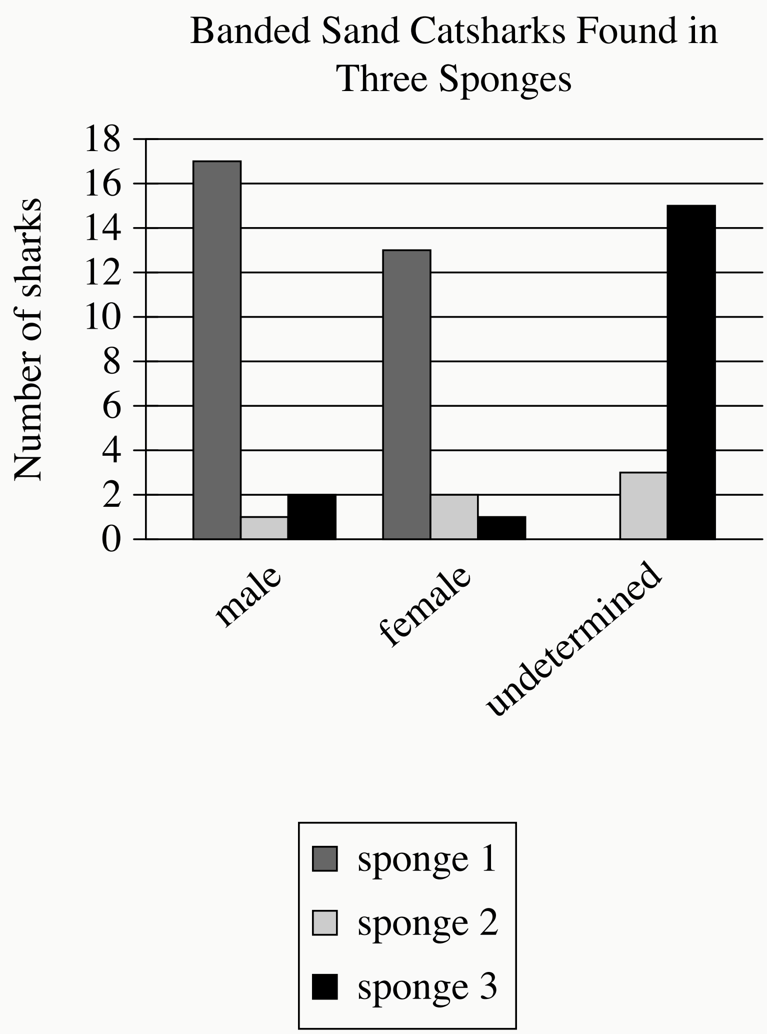
The student wants to emphasize a similarity between glaciers and icebergs in Greenland. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

A. Because icebergs break off Greenland's glaciers into the water, their melting rate depends on water temperature.

B. Greenland's glaciers and icebergs both melt during the year, contributing to rising sea levels.

C. Geoscientist Twila Moon found that the melting rate of Greenland's icebergs, unlike that of glaciers, does not depend on air temperature.

D. Glaciers on the coast of Greenland melt during the warm summer months into the surrounding water, the temperature of which remains consistent throughout the year.



- For each data category, the following bars are shown:
  - sponge 1
  - sponge 2
  - sponge 3
- The Number of sharks data for the 3 categories are as follows:
  - male:
    - sponge 1: 17 sharks
    - sponge 2: 1 shark
    - sponge 3: 2 sharks
  - female:

- sponge 1: 13 sharks
- sponge 2: 2 sharks
- sponge 3: 1 shark
- undetermined:
  - sponge 1: 0 sharks
  - sponge 2: 3 sharks
  - sponge 3: 15 sharks

Researcher Helen O'Neill and her team were studying sponges in the family Irciniidae when they discovered that three of the sponges were functioning as microhabitats for banded sand catsharks (*Atelomycterus fasciatus*). Additionally, the team found that male and female *A. fasciatus* share the same sponge (the same microhabitat), a behavior not found among Port Jackson sharks (*Heterodontus portusjacksoni*), another seabed-dwelling species.

Which choice best describes data from the graph that support the underlined claim?

A. Each of the three sponges was inhabited by at least one male *A. fasciatus* and at least one undetermined *A. fasciatus*.

B. Sponge 1 was inhabited by 17 male *A. fasciatus*.

C. Each of the three sponges was inhabited by at least one male *A. fasciatus* and at least one female *A. fasciatus*.

D. Sponge 1 was inhabited by 13 female *A. fasciatus*.

Q5

INFORMATION AND IDEAS

The practice of logging (cutting down trees for commercial and other uses) is often thought to be at odds with forest conservation (the work of preserving forests). However, a massive study in forest management and preservation spanning 700,000 hectares in Oregon's Malheur National Forest calls that view into question. So far, results of the study suggest that forest plots that have undergone limited logging (the careful removal of a controlled number of trees) may be more robust than plots that haven't been logged at all. These results, in turn, suggest that ______blank

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A. logging may be useful for maintaining healthy forests, provided it is limited.

B. other forest management strategies are more effective than limited logging.

C. as time passes, it will be difficult to know whether limited logging has any benefits.

D. the best way to support forest health may be to leave large forests entirely untouched.

Q6 INFORMATION AND IDEAS

Biologists have predicted that birds' feather structures vary with habitat temperature, but this hadn't been tested in mountain environments. Ornithologist Sahas Barve studied feathers from 249 songbird species inhabiting different elevations—and thus experiencing different temperatures—in the Himalaya Mountains. He found that feathers of high-elevation species not only have a greater proportion of warming downy sections to flat and smooth sections than do feathers of low-elevation species, but high-elevation species' feathers also tend to be longer, providing a thicker layer of insulation.

Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

A. Barve's investigation shows that some species of Himalayan songbirds have evolved feathers that better regulate body temperature than do the feathers of other species, contradicting previous predictions.

B. Barve found an association between habitat temperature and feather structure among Himalayan songbirds, lending new support to a general prediction.

C. Barve discovered that songbirds have adapted to their environment by growing feathers without flat and smooth sections, complicating an earlier hypothesis.

D. The results of Barve's study suggest that the ability of birds to withstand cold temperatures is determined more strongly by feather length than feather structure, challenging an established belief.

Q7

STANDARD ENGLISH CONVENTIONS

Archaeologists have estimated that the pre-Columbian Native American city of Cahokia, located across the Mississippi River from modern-day St. Louis, Missouri, had as many as 20,000 inhabitants in the year 1150 ______blank it one of the largest cities in North America at the time.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A. CE making

B. CE. Making

C. CE, making

D. CE; making

Q8

STANDARD ENGLISH CONVENTIONS

While constructing the Limyra Bridge, ancient Roman builders relied on temporary wooden beams to support the stone and brick structure. These temporary supports, a construction system known as ______blank were removed when the bridge was completed.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A. falsework;

B. falsework

C. falsework,

D. falsework:

Q9

The following text is from Charlotte Perkins Gilman's 1910 poem "The Earth's Entail."

No matter how we cultivate the land,
Taming the forest and the prairie free;
No matter how we irrigate the sand,
Making the desert blossom at command,
  We must always leave the borders of the sea;
  The immeasureable reaches
  Of the windy wave-wet beaches,
The million-mile-long margin of the sea.

Which choice best describes the overall structure of the text?

A. The speaker argues against interfering with nature and then gives evidence supporting this interference.

B. The speaker presents an account of efforts to dominate nature and then cautions that such efforts are only temporary.

C. The speaker provides examples of an admirable way of approaching nature and then challenges that approach.

D. The speaker describes attempts to control nature and then offers a reminder that not all nature is controllable.

Q10

CRAFT AND STRUCTURE

A team of researchers discovered that Matabele ants can identify an infected wound in a member of the colony and then treat the infection by covering the wound with antimicrobial secretions that the ants produce. The team found that the mortality rate for Matabele ants with infected injuries was reduced by 90% with this treatment, and they are hopeful that this discovery could aid in the development of new antibiotics for human use.

Which choice best describes the overall structure of the text?

A. It summarizes research findings on Matabele ants and then identifies an area for further research.

B. It introduces a study of Matabele ants and then explains the research methods used in the study.

C. It describes unique properties of Matabele ants and then speculates on how those properties evolved.

D. It identifies an issue concerning Matabele ants and then proposes a solution to address the issue.